

1 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Mystery object bag

What we are practising

Practise naming objects and describing their uses.

What you need

Cloth bag / Large spoon / Small towel / Large toy car

Hide one object behind your back instead of using a bag.

Before you begin

Place three familiar, safe objects in the bag.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Describe the spoon: "We use this to eat soup."
2. Let your child guess, then show the object.
3. Invite your child to choose another object and give you a clue.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What else could you tell me without saying its name?

Space to explore

2 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

One-sentence story circle

What we are practising

Connect spoken ideas and listen to another speaker.

What you need

No materials

A favourite soft toy can be the story character.

Before you begin

Sit together and choose a familiar animal.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Begin: "A little cat found a hat."
2. Ask your child what the cat does next; repeat their idea in a sentence.
3. Add one sentence each, then finish with the cat returning home.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What happened after the cat tried on the hat?

Space to explore

3 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Animal sound detective

What we are practising

Associate familiar sounds with names and take speaking turns.

What you need

No materials

Point to familiar animal pictures if making sounds is uncomfortable.

Before you begin

Choose three animals your child already knows.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Make a gentle “meow” and ask which animal it could be.
2. Name the cat together and describe one feature, such as whiskers.
3. Let your child make a different sound for you to identify.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What clue helped you decide?

Space to explore

4 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Where is Teddy?

What we are practising

Use and understand on, under and beside.

What you need

Soft toy / Cushion

Use a rolled pair of socks instead of a toy.

Before you begin

Put the cushion on the floor with space around it.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Put Teddy on the cushion and say “on”.
2. Ask the child to put Teddy under, then beside, the cushion.
3. Swap roles so your child tells you where Teddy should go.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Can you show me beside without covering Teddy?

Space to explore

5 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

My day in three pictures

What we are practising

Use first, next and last to describe an order.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Act out the three actions instead of drawing.

Before you begin

Draw a cup, toothbrush and shoes in three separate spaces.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Ask your child what each picture might mean.
2. Choose the order that matches your family's morning.
3. Point to each picture and tell the routine using first, next and last.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What do you usually do before putting on your shoes?

Space to explore

6 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

The opposite of wet

What we are practising

Understand an everyday opposite.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

One towel is wet. The other has no water in it. Is the other towel wet or dry?

Space to explore

7 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Which word is an action?

What we are practising

Recognise an action word.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A rabbit is jumping. Which word tells what it is doing: rabbit or jumping?

Space to explore

8 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Who is carrying the bag?

What we are practising

Answer a who question.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Lina carries a bag. Her dog walks beside her. Who carries the bag?

Space to explore

9 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Where did the book go?

What we are practising

Find a location in speech.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Omar puts a book on the sofa, then sits on a chair. Where is the book?

Space to explore

10 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

The fruit group

What we are practising

Use a familiar category word.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

An apple, a banana and a sock are named. Which two are fruit?

Space to explore

11 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

A quiet voice

What we are practising

Connect describing words with meaning.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

We want a quiet voice for a sleeping toy. Would we whisper or shout?

Space to explore

12 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

A small word for Maya

What we are practising

Use a pronoun for a named person.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Maya is a girl. Maya is smiling. Can we say “She is smiling” instead?

Space to explore

13 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Listen, then move

What we are practising

Follow two spoken instructions.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

First touch your head; then wave. Which action should you do first?

Space to explore

14 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

A cup for a drink

What we are practising

Link an object name with its use.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

The toy wants a drink. Should its friend bring a cup or a pillow?

Space to explore

15 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

One and more in words

What we are practising

Notice how words show quantity.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

We say one bird. If there are two, do we say two bird or two birds?

Space to explore

16 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Hear the word beats

What we are practising

Notice spoken syllables.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Clap the beats in banana: ba-na-na. How many beats did you hear?

Space to explore

17 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Finish the hungry sentence

What we are practising

Choose a word that fits a sentence.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Finish: "I am hungry, so I want to ..." Is eat or sleep the closer fit?

Space to explore

18 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

How does the fish move?

What we are practising

Select a suitable movement verb.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A fish moves through water. Which word fits: swims or climbs?

Space to explore

19 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Choose the describing word

What we are practising

Match an adjective to a stated feature.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A cushion bends easily when pressed. Would soft or hard describe it better?

Space to explore

20 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Which sentence asks?

What we are practising

Distinguish a question from a greeting.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Listen: "Hello, Sami." "Where is Sami?" Which one asks for information?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Mystery object bag

A little hint

Name an action: eating, drying or rolling.

Answer / what to notice

A spoon fits the soup clue; accept other objects that fit a child's clue.

A useful clue describes what an object does or what it is like.

Make it easier

Show two objects and let the child point to one.

Take it further

Give two clues before anyone guesses.

Another day, away from the screen

Describe three objects while tidying the room.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. One-sentence story circle

A little hint

Offer a choice: did it dance or visit a friend?

Answer / what to notice

Any connected, comfortable story is welcome; there is no fixed ending.

Taking turns makes room for both storytellers' ideas.

Make it easier

Let your child supply one word or animal sound.

Take it further

Recall the beginning, middle and ending together.

Another day, away from the screen

Retell the story to a toy at bedtime.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Animal sound detective

A little hint

Offer two names: cat or duck?

Answer / what to notice

“Meow” suggests a cat; accept the family’s usual sound words.

Different languages may write animal sounds differently while naming the same animal.

Make it easier

Make the sound and show the matching animal gesture.

Take it further

Give a feature clue without making its sound.

Another day, away from the screen

Listen for real bird sounds from a safe place together.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Where is Teddy?

A little hint

Model one position with your hand first.

Answer / what to notice

On means resting above the cushion; under means below it; beside means next to it.

Moving a real object gives each position word a visible example.

Make it easier

Practise only on and under.

Take it further

Try a two-part instruction: beside the cushion, then on it.

Another day, away from the screen

Use the same words when putting toys away.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. My day in three pictures

A little hint

Describe one real morning rather than an ideal routine.

Answer / what to notice

The order can differ between families; a clear explanation matters.

Sequence words help a listener follow events in order.

Make it easier

Use only two pictures.

Take it further

Add a fourth picture and explain where it belongs.

Another day, away from the screen

Draw an evening routine another day.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

6. The opposite of wet

A little hint

Think about how each towel would feel.

Answer / what to notice

Dry.

Dry describes something without the wetness mentioned in the question.

Make it easier

Say both choices while pretending to touch the towels.

Take it further

Name the opposite of open.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

7. Which word is an action?

A little hint

You can act out the doing word.

Answer / what to notice

Jumping.

Rabbit names the animal; jumping describes its action.

Make it easier

Demonstrate jumping with two fingers.

Take it further

Choose another action a rabbit could do.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

8. Who is carrying the bag?

A little hint

Listen for the person named before “carries”.

Answer / what to notice

Lina.

The sentence says Lina carries it; the dog is walking.

Make it easier

Choose between Lina and the dog.

Take it further

Say what the dog is doing in a full sentence.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

9. Where did the book go?

A little hint

Where he sits is not where he puts the book.

Answer / what to notice

On the sofa.

The book stays in the place stated in the first part.

Make it easier

Repeat only the first part.

Take it further

Answer a second question: where is Omar sitting?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

10. The fruit group

A little hint

Fruit is something we might eat.

Answer / what to notice

The apple and banana.

They belong to the fruit group; a sock is clothing.

Make it easier

Choose between an apple and a sock.

Take it further

Name one more fruit.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

11. A quiet voice

A little hint

Which choice makes a softer sound?

Answer / what to notice

Whisper.

A whisper is quiet; a shout is loud.

Make it easier

An adult models a gentle whisper only.

Take it further

Find another situation for a quiet voice.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

12. A small word for Maya

A little hint

The small word still refers to Maya.

Answer / what to notice

Yes; she means Maya here.

A pronoun can replace a name already mentioned.

Make it easier

Repeat “Maya is smiling. She is smiling.”

Take it further

Replace Omar’s name in “Omar is waving”.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

13. Listen, then move

A little hint

Listen for the word first.

Answer / what to notice

Touch your head.

First marks the beginning; then introduces the next action.

Make it easier

Do the actions with the adult.

Take it further

Give the adult two different instructions.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

14. A cup for a drink

A little hint

Which object can hold a drink?

Answer / what to notice

A cup.

A cup holds a drink; a pillow supports a head.

Make it easier

Pretend to drink from an empty hand.

Take it further

Explain what a pillow is useful for.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

15. One and more in words

A little hint

The word changes when the amount changes.

Answer / what to notice

Two birds.

English adds s here; the spoken phrase names more than one bird.

Make it easier

Repeat the correct pair with one then two fingers.

Take it further

Try one cat and two cats.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

16. Hear the word beats

A little hint

Give one clap for each spoken part.

Answer / what to notice

Three beats in banana.

Each spoken syllable gets one clap; this is listening, not counting letters.

Make it easier

Copy the adult's claps slowly.

Take it further

Compare with the one-beat word cat.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

17. Finish the hungry sentence

A little hint

What usually helps with hunger?

Answer / what to notice

Eat.

Eating directly fits the stated need for food.

Make it easier

Offer the two words with simple gestures.

Take it further

Finish a new sentence beginning "I am sleepy".

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

18. How does the fish move?

A little hint

Imagine moving through a pond.

Answer / what to notice

Swims.

Swimming describes the fish's movement through water.

Make it easier

Make a swimming motion with one hand.

Take it further

Name a movement word for a bird in the air.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

19. Choose the describing word

A little hint

Think of a cushion compared with a stone.

Answer / what to notice

Soft.

Soft fits the cushion's easy yielding in this example.

Make it easier

Gently touch a familiar cushion with adult help.

Take it further

Describe a cushion using a different word, such as big.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

20. Which sentence asks?

A little hint

Which sentence needs an answer about a place?

Answer / what to notice

Where is Sami?

Where asks about a place; hello is a greeting.

Make it easier

Repeat both sentences with natural voices.

Take it further

Ask a question starting with who.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.